SUBTRACTION WORD PROBLEMS

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read each problem twice. Decide what is being taken away or compared, write a column subtraction in the box, then answer with a unit.

1 A library had 85 picture books on the shelf. By closing time 47 had been borrowed. How many were left on the shelf?

show your working

Answer: _____ books

2 Ava is saving for a bike that costs 92 dollars. She has 56 dollars so far. How much more does she need?

show your working

Answer: _____ dollars

3 A farmer picked 324 apples. He sold 168 at the market. How many apples does he still have?

show your working

Answer: _____ apples

4 The school hall has 400 chairs. 237 of them are already set out. How many chairs are still stacked?

show your working

Answer: _____ chairs

5 A plane can carry 512 passengers. On one flight 386 seats were sold. How many seats were empty?

show your working

Answer: _____ seats

6 A charity walk is 750 metres long. Sam has walked 485 metres. How far does he still have to walk?

show your working

Answer: _____ metres

SUBTRACTION WORD PROBLEMS

ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Answers with one possible number sentence for each problem.

1 A library had 85 picture books on the shelf. By closing time 47 had been borrowed. How many were left on the shelf?

Number sentence: **85 - 47 = 38**

Answer: **38** books

2 Ava is saving for a bike that costs 92 dollars. She has 56 dollars so far. How much more does she need?

Number sentence: **92 - 56 = 36**

Answer: **36** dollars

3 A farmer picked 324 apples. He sold 168 at the market. How many apples does he still have?

Number sentence: **324 - 168 = 156**

Answer: **156** apples

4 The school hall has 400 chairs. 237 of them are already set out. How many chairs are still stacked?

Number sentence: **400 - 237 = 163**

Answer: **163** chairs

5 A plane can carry 512 passengers. On one flight 386 seats were sold. How many seats were empty?

Number sentence: **512 - 386 = 126**

Answer: **126** seats

6 A charity walk is 750 metres long. Sam has walked 485 metres. How far does he still have to walk?

Number sentence: **750 - 485 = 265**

Answer: **265** metres